



PHOTO BY GETTY IMAGES



INDIAN JEWELS GO GLOBAL Meryl Streep wore Hanut Singh's earrings on the Cannes red carpet



“Today I work with master craftsmen in India but also have a percentage of setting work done abroad”

Hanut Singh
FOUNDER,
HANUT SINGH

don, Los Angeles, and New York, Singh is a darling of the global jet-setters. The list of his patrons include Beyonce, Cher, Madonna, Kate Winslet, and Katy Perry, among others, while Bollywood stars such as Kareena Kapoor and Alia Bhatt are often seen wearing his creations. “My aesthetic and design seem to reverberate with people across cultures,” says Singh, who is self-taught. A descendent of the Kapurthala royal family, Singh has had the privilege of growing up surrounded by beautiful jewellery created by masters of the craft. “Today I work with master craftsmen in India but also have a percentage of setting work done abroad,” says Singh, whose talismanic designs, such as the dagger, are very popular. “I’ve always loved talismanic jewels and design, and the dagger is so symbolic of protection. It’s a Sikh symbol. It reverberates with me,” says the 51-year-old.

For Mumbai-based Kamyen, being small and exclusive is its USP. “Our clients like their pieces to be exclusive. They enjoy the fact that these are one-off, made only for them,” says Pooja Gandhi, who handles the family business in Dubai and the Middle East. While the jewellery is designed by her mother along with a team of designers, all the manufacturing and production is overseen by her father in Mumbai. The Gandhis were traditionally in the diamond trade and moved from Belgium to Mumbai in 2005 and moved into jewellery.

The recent sightings of Cardi B and Alia Bhatt wearing Kamyen jewellery have undoubtedly brought this ‘by appointment only’ jewellery house into the limelight. “When Cardi B’s stylist got in touch, we agreed because it was for the Met Gala, which is the epitome of fashion,” says Gandhi. While their high-end jewellery is a one-off and they don’t repeat a piece, in 2018 they launched their Pret-a-Porter collection comprising everyday diamond jewellery, available online globally on sites such as Net-a-Porter.

With global celebs taking note of India’s rich jewellery heritage and artisanal savoir-faire, Indian jewellery designers continue to shine bright. **BT**

@smitabw